

Isaac Newton

The Questions in Everyday Things

The true story of a boy who built a mouse-powered windmill and split sunlight into a rainbow, and whose questions about a falling apple explained how the Moon moves.

Before reading

Look at the cover. What is Isaac holding? Where do you think the rainbow comes from?

While reading

1. What did Isaac build that a mouse could turn?
2. Why did the neighbours think Isaac's kite was a comet?
3. What happened when sunlight went through the glass prism?

After reading

1. Isaac asked why apples fall straight down. What everyday thing do you wonder about?
2. Isaac wasn't a very good farmer, but he was good at other things. What are you good at?
3. "Standing on the shoulders of giants" means learning from others. Who helps you learn?

The big idea

Look. Ask. Test.

When your child asks a question, try: "Let's look closely, ask what might happen, and test it."

Try this together

A fair test. Drop two things at the same time, such as a sock and a shoe. Guess which will land first, test it three times, and talk about what you saw.

Words to talk about

gravity · prism · rainbow · orbit · telescope · test

Tips for reading aloud: pause on the pictures and let children notice details first. There are no wrong answers to these questions; follow your child's curiosity. The back of the book has four simple experiments to try, and a free activity pack is at tarkasatales.com/activities.

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